First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 11
Sacred Earth, Sacred Soul ~ Sacred Compassion
15 November 2026

Preaching: LVF
Worship Leading: ML & Youth

Strips of paper in programs for prayers

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Michael & … center chancel]

Welcome **ML**

Words of Gathering **ML &**
On this day, Holy One, help us to remember
that all things are born of you.

We carry within us your light and your life.
In the mystery of matter
and deep in the cells of our souls
are your longings for oneness.

The oneness of the universe
vast and vibrating with the sound of its beginning.
The oneness of the earth
greening and teeming as a single body.
The oneness of the human soul
a sacred countenance in infinite form.

On this day, grant us your longings for oneness, Holy One,
amidst life's glorious multiplicities.
[jphilipnewell]

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering.

***Hymn of Gathering**

Praise to God, the World's Creator - ODE TO JOY.pdf

[Michael center chancel]

***Prayer of Awareness** **ML**

***Introit**

[... to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

Our Holy Scriptures tell us that we are all created in the image and likeness of God.
In this place, we celebrate the Mystery of who God is.
We remember that our tradition is rich in calling The Divine by many names:
Amma, Abba, Loving Mother, Compassionate Father, Source of Life, Redeemer,
Loving Presence, Holy One, Adonai…

Because of this Mystery, we invite you to pray The Lord's Prayer
in your own tradition and language.
In this way, we celebrate the interconnectedness of our lives,
whether we come from near or from far.
Let us now pray together as Jesus taught us…

Our [God], who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy Name,
thy kin-dom come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our debts,
as we forgive our debtors.
And lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom,
and the power, and the glory,
forever.
Amen.

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,

As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Michael center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace** **ML**

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are now invited to share this greeting with those near you.

Please be seated

[... to lectern]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition ***from Ezekiel***

Hear now these words from the Prophet Ezekiel in the Hebrew Bible…

This is the witness of the people.
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph short transition Michael center chancel]

Prayers with the People **Ml**

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

—

As we share these moments of silence, we are invited to write the prayers of our hearts for our lives and the life of our world on the slips of paper in our programs. If you are online, please share your prayers by emailing prayers@fccla.org.

Then, as the music begins, we are invited to come forward to share our prayers here in the bowl, and to light candles signifying our prayers, for ourselves, those we love and hold dear - and for the life of the world.

Let us now be in silence, together.

Silence

Prayer of Our Hearts
For the wisdom that fashioned the universe
and can be read in earth's dark depths
and in heaven's infinity of lights
thanks be to you, O God.

For the wisdom of teachers before us
and their words and imaginative seeing,
for the wisdom of the those we have known
and their silence and humility of speech,
and for wisdom's wellspring in our own souls
and in the soul of every human being
from which ancient truths and new realizations spring forth,
thanks be to you.

Let wisdom unfold in our hearts and minds
and in the people of every nation.
Let us see the foundations for a new harmony
within us and between us,
the foundations for a recovered unity
with the earth and all its creatures,
for the ground of life is in you, O God,
the ground of all life is in you.
Amen and Amen.

[Christoph transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit, choir to seats]

Sermon ***Sacred Compassion*** **LVF**

[Christoph transition … to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

Today, we invite your offerings for our Community Gardens & Urban Farm here at the Cathedral. These spaces across our 5-acre campus have been intentionally transformed for the growing and sharing of food with our beloved neighbors across Koreatown and Westlake. This food, chosen specifically for the culinary traditions of our neighbors, includes: over 60 fruit trees, a medicinal, culinary, and butterfly garden with herbs for cooking, healing, and struggling

Monarch populations, and over 30 raised beds containing varieties of greens and healthy vegetables.

Our Gardens & Farm also serve as educational spaces for local area schools and organizations like HOLA, and are more frequently being used as space for nurturing spirituality, community, and reconnection with the beloved earth.

Thank you for joining us in this expansive vision, as we become the best neighbors we can be in our neighborhood.

In the gift of this new day,
in the gift of the present moment,
in the gift of time and eternity intertwined
let us be thankful
let us be attentive
let us be open to what has never happened before,
in the gift of this new day,
in the gift of the present moment,
in the gift of time and eternity intertwined.

Gardens QR Code

Offertory Anthem

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**
From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[... to lectern toward end of doxology]

***Offering Prayer**
PAUSE and then begin
Thanks be to you, O God,
for the stirrings of new life in us this day,
from rising from the dreams of the night
to a fresh flowing of energy,

for the vitality that awakened our bodies
and the desires that stir our souls.

Let us know the power for life that is in us,
the life-force that is in our senses
and the might that is within our hearts.

Let us know you as the source of such force
and be wise to its true streams and false currents.

As we leave this sacred time and place,
let us serve love with our strength this day,
let us serve love with our strength.
In heart and mind and body this day
let us serve love.

[JPhilipNewelladapt/lvf]

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us.
Amen and Amen!

Please be seated

[Laura & Michael center chancel]

Life at First Church **ML & LVF**

Words of Blessing **LVF**

The blessings of the sun
the blessings of the moon
the blessings of east and west
to guide us on this way
to lighten our eyes
to strengthen our will and our loving.

The blessings of earth
the blessings of air
the blessings of fire and water
to fill us with heaven
to free us with mercy
to stir us with flames of compassion.

May it ever be so.

Choral Response

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

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Inside The Music- Dr. Ianthe Marini